Charts that tell the truth

Data science · Level 1 · Lesson 3



Today we will

- Choose bar, line, pie or scatter for a question.
- Spot a cut axis.
- Read a chart’s title, axes and units.

Remember

- Bars compare groups; lines show time.
- Pies: a few parts of one whole.
- Bars start at zero.

Same data, four charts

1. Warm-up (5 min): Which chart is wrong?
2. Teach (8 min): Four charts, four questions.
3. Draw (15 min): Each group, a different chart.
4. Gallery (7 min): Vote and spot the trick.
5. Wrap-up (5 min): What did we find out?

Let’s discuss

1. Which chart would you use for attendance over a term?
2. Why do bars have to start at zero, but lines don’t always?
3. Where have you seen a misleading chart?

Exit ticket

- Draw a tiny honest bar chart of two numbers, with a title and labelled axes.